Multicellular organisms

A multicellular organism is a living thing that is made up of many cells. This category of things has many different organisms in it. Everything from a tiny jellyfish to a human is a multicellular organism – but jellyfish and humans aren't much alike in other ways. Scientists usually break up multicellular organisms into smaller categories using the system of biological classification.

☞ **1** What does the prefix 'multi-' mean?

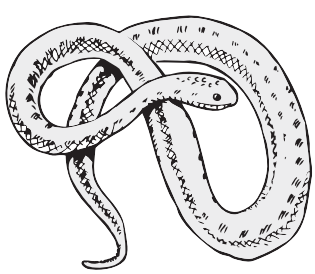
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2 Which of these types of organisms are multicellular? Circle them.

- animals
- plants
- amoebae
- bacteria

3 All the organisms listed below are multicellular organisms. Think about what some of these different things have in common. Group them into two or three groups. Write the name of each group, describe the shared features of the group and list each of the organisms.
Hint: There is no right or wrong answer, just different ways of grouping things.





- sea star
- earthworm
- crab
- banksia
- duck
- mushroom
- snake
- sunflower

Group name			
Shared features			
Organisms			

ISBN 978 1 92571 063 2
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Multicellular organisms CONT'D

4 Imagine a tropical rainforest. Look at this list of some multicellular organisms that could be found there. Use the table to organise your list of organisms into the areas of the rainforest where they can be found.

vines	butterflies	turtles	dragonflies
fungi	owls	worms	lichen
short bushes	ferns	bats	grasshoppers
mice	bacteria	alligators	eels
frogs	monkeys	orchids	possums
water snakes	wild turkeys	parrots	moss

On the ground (dark and wet)	Near the ground (shady and green)	High up in the trees (sunny, dry and warm)	In the water and marshes (shallow and cool)

5 Compare your answers to Question 4 with a classmate. Which organisms did you categorise differently? Discuss why.

6 Give another way that you could group the organisms in Question 4.

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